

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 7 2

♥ 10 9 3

♦ A 4

♣ J 9 8 4

♠ K J 8 3

♥ Q 7 5

♦ 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5

♥ A K J 6 4 2

♦ K Q 9 6 5

♣ Q

♠ A Q 6 4

♥ 8

♦ J 10 8 2

♣ A 10 7 3

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

2♠

1♥

Dbl

All Pass

2♠ by North

The bidding has been as shown.

This is certainly not a great hand, but at least the shape is good. You should strive to get into the bidding whenever possible, and with this hand the only way in is to double. Partner jumps to 2♠ and it is your bid again.

Partner shows 9-11 points and a ♠ suit. However, he didn't force you to game, and you barely scraped up the double to begin with. So you pass.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q 6 4
 ♥ 8
 ♦ A 10 8 2
 ♣ A 10 7 3

♠ 10 7 5 2

♥ J 10 6

♦ J 9 6

♣ Q 9 4



♠ K J 8 3

♥ Q 7 5

♦ 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

♠ 9

♥ A K 9 4 3 2

♦ K Q 5 4

♣ J 8

*West**North**East**South*

Dbl

Pass

2 ♠

1 ♥

4 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

The bidding has been as shown.

This is almost the hand you held in Deal 4 - just 3 points stronger in ♦s. So you double, and again partner jumps to 2 ♠.

That extra 3 points makes all the difference. With that singleton ♥ your hand is now worth at least 16 points. Add partner's 9, 10 or 11 and you are at game level. Bid 4 ♠.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 3 2
 ♥ 8 6 2
 ♦ 5 2
 ♣ J 10 6 4 3

♠ K Q 9 5

♥ A J 7 3

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 7



♠ A 7

♥ 10 9 5

♦ K Q J 10 8 4

♣ Q 2

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ A 7

♣ A 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦	3 ♦	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

The bidding has been as shown.

You'd really like to have 4-card support for both Majors when you double a Minor. But it's not a requirement. So you double and hear partner respond 2 ♦. East then chips in with 3 ♦. What now?

Don't let East's bid bother you, he's just trying to push the envelope. You have a good hand and partner's bid shows 12+ points and is forcing to game. Now you have to find the right game, and the best way to start is by showing a 4-card Major suit. You bid 3 ♠.

That was what partner needed to hear, he bids 4 ♠.